



Indri
(*Indri indri*)
Body length: up to
2 ft 4 in (72 cm)
Tail: up to 2 in (5 cm)

Noisy lemur

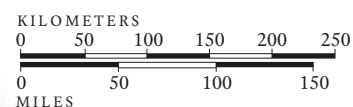
The indri is the largest and loudest of all lemurs. Its wails can be heard 2 miles (3 km) away, and if a family calls together, the sound is deafening. Indris can probably identify individuals in other groups by their cries. When an indri is alarmed, it makes a different, hooting call.



**WEST INDIAN OCEAN
COELACANTH**



Grasses are the main form of vegetation on Madagascar's central plateau.



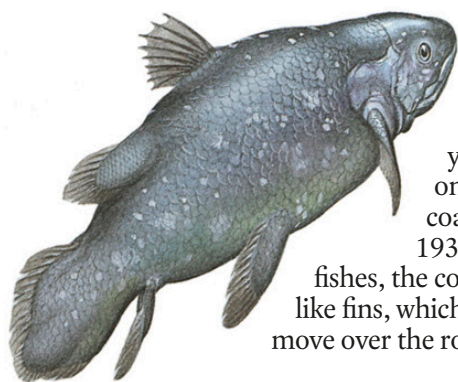
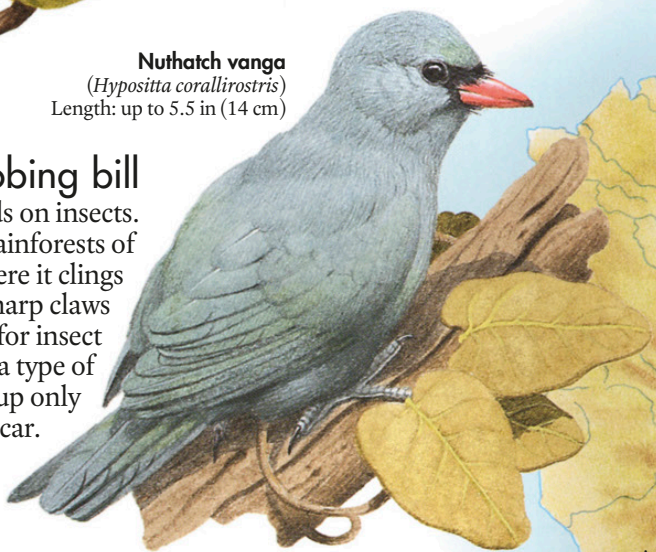
There is a plain about 30 miles (50 km) wide along the eastern coast of Madagascar.

Nuthatch vanga
(*Hypositta corallirostris*)
Length: up to 5.5 in (14 cm)

Probing bill

The nuthatch vanga feeds on insects.

It lives in the humid rainforests of eastern Madagascar, where it clings to tree trunks with its sharp claws and probes the bark for insect grubs with its bill. It is a type of vanga shrike, a bird group only found on Madagascar.



West Indian Ocean coelacanth
(*Latimeria chalumnae*)
Length: up to 6 ft 7 in (2 m)

Living fossil

Scientists believed the coelacanth had died out 70 million years ago until a live one was caught off the coast of Madagascar in 1938. Like other ancient fishes, the coelacanth has limb-like fins, which probably help it move over the rocky sea floor.

Bush pig
(*Potamochoerus larvatus*)
Body length: up to 5 ft (1.5 m)
Tail: up to 16 in (40 cm)



Hairy back

The bush pig, or wild boar, has a mane of long, whitish hairs along its back. It uses its long, sensitive nose to sniff out roots, insects, and worms but will eat almost anything. Bush pigs are often hunted because they cause a lot of damage to crops.



Pink-winged stick insect
(*Sipylodea sipylus*)
Length: up to 4 in (10 cm)

Twiggy body

More than 90 percent of Madagascan insect species are not found elsewhere in the world. They include dozens of stick insect species. Their long, thin bodies look so much like twigs that they are almost impossible for enemies to spot.



Forests once covered much of Madagascar. The few forests that remain today are home to a huge variety of plants and animals.

Parson's chameleon
(*Calumma parsonii*)
Length: up to 27 in (68 cm)

Pincer toes

Parson's chameleon has hands and feet like pincers, which allow it to get a firm grip on branches and plants. Chameleons can change color according to their mood or to match their surroundings. This camouflages them from enemies and helps them creep up on their prey without being seen.

